

Next Meeting:
August 7, 2011
Join us for the MVHA's:
Annual BBQ
See Page 7 for more info

Newsletter* See Below

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume I *Issue 2* *Summer 2011*

**Newsletter name will be announced at the BBQ! Thanks to all who submitted!*

Highlights:

Zesty Burger Time!



If you haven't already, fill out your order for the annual MVHA BBQ!
Page 7

Mtn. View Memories

"Remembering John J. Pear" and "Life on Central Avenue"
Page 4

Contents:

News & Notes	2
Mtn. View Memories	4
Membership	6
Street Talk	7
Calendar	8



President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President

Hi Everyone,

The Board is very pleased that we have heard such positive comments about the new format of this Newsletter, and we again want to express our appreciation to the Newsletter Editor, Nick Perry. A new look needs a new name. The contest to name the Newsletter ended on July 15th, and the winning name will be announced at the BBQ.

Speaking of the BBQ, if you haven't already sent in your RSVP for the BBQ, don't forget to do so now. Another BBQ RSVP form is included in this newsletter – join us for great Hamburgers and have a fun afternoon with fellow MVHA members and friends. The date of the BBQ is Sunday, August 7th and will again be held at the Adobe Building.

Can't make it this year? You can still buy raffle tickets since you don't need to be present to win. There will also be some great items for the Silent Auction Tables and more keep coming in. A sample of some of the items on the silent auction table: two tickets to a performance of your choice at the Mtn. View Center for the Performing Arts, dinner for four cooked just for you by Mountain View Firefighters, two tickets to the Winchester Mystery House, or what about gift certificates to Ristorante Don Giovanni or Cascal Restaurant. ***(continued on page 3)***

Summer '11 Calendar

SUMMER 2011
General Membership Meeting
Sunday, Aug. 7, 2011 at 1PM
Featuring the MVHA's:
Annual Barbeque!
Zesty Burgers, Raffle, and Silent Auction
See **Page 7** for Order Form



At the historic
Adobe Building
157 Moffett Boulevard at Central Expressway
(Parking in the rear off Central Avenue)

August 7, 2011
MVHA Annual BBQ &
General Membership Meeting
Adobe Building, 1pm
See Page 7 for more info & order form

September 10-11, 2011
Mtn. View Art & Wine Festival
Contact us if you'd like to volunteer to help staff an MVHA information table by e-mailing:
info@mountainviewhistorical.org

Save the Date:
November 6, 2011
MVHA General Membership Meeting
More information in our Fall newsletter!



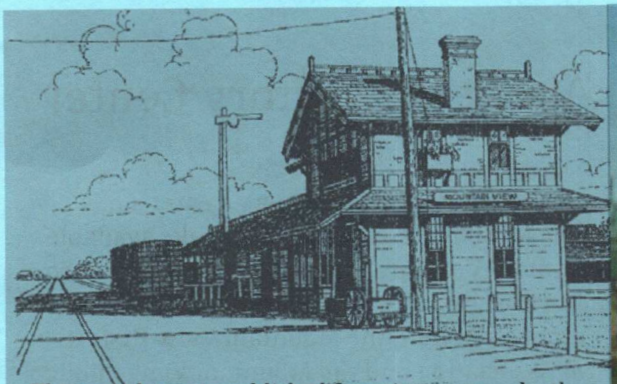
Newsletter*

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, Ca 94042

The Newsletter's new name will be announced at the annual BBQ on Aug. 7. Read inside for details.

FIRST CLASS MAIL

WEB: *mountainviewhistorical.org*
E-MAIL: *info@mountainviewhistorical.org*



This newsletter is published four times a year by the:
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

BOARD MEMBERS & CHAIRS

President: Patricia Figueroa
Vice-President: Cliff Del Carlo
Secretary: Jamil Shaikh
Treasurer: John Figueroa
Past President: Bob Weaver
Historical Data: Barbara Kinchen
Membership: June Casey
Newsletter Editor: Nick Perry
Ways & Means: Richard Espinosa
Director-at Large: Nick Galiotto
Hospitality: Helene Hughes
Memorial & Remembrances: Trudi Tuban
Programs: Bob Weaver
Publicity: Vacant

Become a Member Today!

See Page 6 on how to join!

In Memoriam

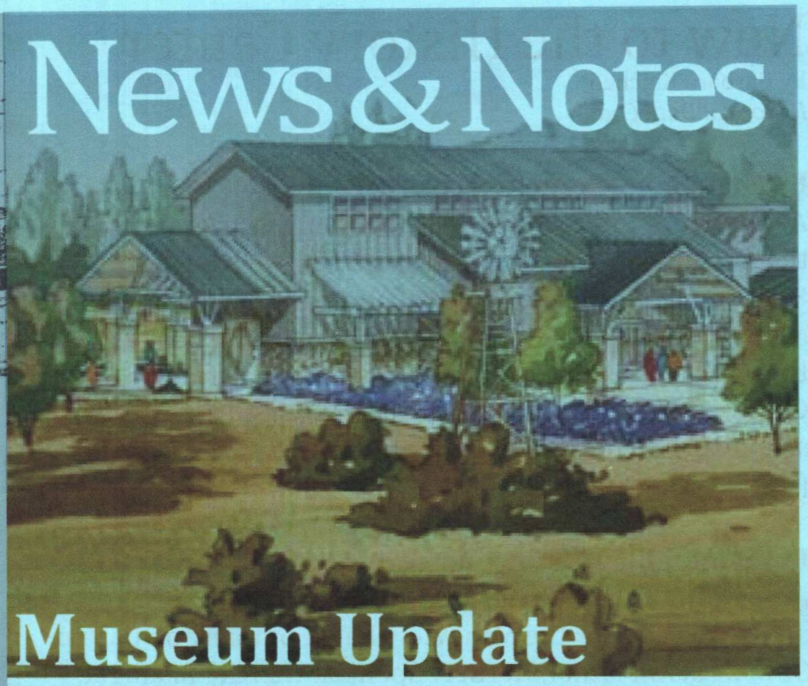
John Joseph Pear
August 30, 1928~ April 7, 2011

Peter J. Spily
June 17, 1916 ~ April 14, 2011

Billie Jean Yancey Davies
November 6, 1925~ May 21, 2011

Louie P. Givich
June 19, 1911~ June 12, 2011

News & Notes



Museum Update

By Bob Weaver
Past President and Programs Chair

The Museum Project Team has been extremely busy with the final details of the Pearson House proposal that would add a history house to our museum site at Cuesta Park. The Pearson House dates from 1888 and will be a grand 1st step toward the establishment of our History Museum.

The feeling of "a sense of place" is challenging in an urbanized area and especially difficult if one has no knowledge of the area's evolution. The inclusion of the Pearson House with our History Museum would preserve a rich layer of local history, a snapshot in time. Like the Gilbert Smith House at the Los Altos Museum, the Pearson House would be a window into the past.

This is an exciting opportunity and our project team members have put in hundreds of hours of their time and talent to make it a reality. It would be very encouraging to us if members of this association would publicly support our efforts by writing letters of support for the Pearson House and the History Museum, and send them to the *Mountain View Voice* and the *Los Altos Town Crier* for publication. Use your voice to keep the dream moving forward.

Show your support by sending letters to:

Mountain View Voice
450 Cambridge Ave.
Palo Alto, CA 94306
Editor@mv-voice.com

Los Altos Town Crier
138 Main Street
Los Altos, CA 94022
info@latc.com

New to the History Center

By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Chair

From member John Hirschbek:
A number of interesting items including yearbooks from the Adventist Academy, Mountain View High School and Escuela Avenue School; several photos of Castro Street events including Louis Hirschbek, John's father; Oaks Dairy cardboard bottle cap and a small plate from Andy's Chinese Restaurant. There are also about 40 programs for school and faculty plays at Mountain View High School (Castro Street campus).

From member Austin Spencer:
Account book from early 1930s showing items, prices, and purchases for the Mtn. View Fuel Company on Castro Street. Austin father, Herbert Spencer, was the manager. Coal was sold by the sack or by the ton while wood blocks and kindling was by sack.

Unknown donor:
Small plastic megaphone with the words "Awalt High School Spartans."

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 3/16/11: $ 12,868.74
- Income: $ 532.25
- Expenses: $ 733.97

Checking Account Balance as of 6/12/11: $ 12,667.12

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/12/11: $78,919.37
Including $ 31,037.86 designated for the Museum.

Presidents Message *(continued from page 1)*

On May 22nd the Historical Association participated in the 20th anniversary celebration for the Rengstorff House called "Victorian Life: Inside Out". We had a display showing dried apricots, and we also distributed Walking Tour Books of Downtown Mountain View's Historic Homes and Historic Buildings. Thank you to Richard Espinosa and Hip Telmont for spending the day at the Rengstorff House representing Mountain View Historical.
See you at the BBQ!

About the History Center

The Mountain View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the Mountain View Historical Association and the Mountain View Public Library. Historical books and pamphlets on the history of Mountain View are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Location:
Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street
Mountain View, CA 94041

Hours:
The history center is open to the general public from 1-5pm every Tuesday and by appointment.

Call 650-903-6890 for more information.



Go Green!
See the Newsletter in
FULL COLOR
Save paper and resources by e-mailing us at *mvha.newsletter@gmail.com* to receive the newsletter as an Adobe PDF.

Mtn. VIEW Memories

Remembering John J. Pear



John J. Pear c. 1937 with dog Scotty
Courtesy Matt Pear

On April 7, 2011, longtime MVHA member and life-long Mountain View & Los Altos resident John Pear passed away. His son Matt Pear shares with us this account of his father's life.

My father, John Pear was born in 1928 at his family's ranch on Ortega Avenue, then named Calderon Avenue, to Martin and Milica Pear. The Pears were one of Mtn. View's pioneer families, having emigrated from Austria, now Croatia, in the late 1800s. During his childhood John experienced the deprivation of the Great Depression first hand and learned the values of hard work, capriciousness, and inherent risks in farming. As a child he was put to work irrigating strawberries where venture capital companies on Sandhill Road now stand. This experience was a constant influence throughout his life and molded his investment principles, work ethic, and political perspective.

John graduated from Mtn. View High School where he was Student Body President, was selected for Boys State, and excelled in football. The San Jose State *Spartan Daily* heralded his arrival by writing, "With his reputation as 'Lineman of the Year' in 1946, and his selection as All Santa Clara Valley Athletic League tackle in 1945 and 1946, John Pear, 190 pounder, comes from Mtn. View High School, and appears to have won himself a starting berth on 'Bud' Winters' freshman football squad." After earning an AA degree in business, he worked for an advertising firm in San Francisco that required business trips to Hollywood - quite an experience for someone from this area.

In high school he met his beloved wife of 56 years, Edna, and they had two sons, myself (Matt) and my brother Mark. Shortly after being married, he was drafted into the US Army and stationed in Berlin, Germany. After completing his tour of duty he became a contractor whose crew worked on Silicon Valley construction projects, including his own developments. As a landlord, he constantly worried about tenants and keeping expenses at an absolute minimum so he could pass the savings on them; he saw far too many families lose their land due to financial hardships and escalating property taxes and assessments.

My father insisted that my brother and I work on the ranch tending to crops and that we learn the construction trades, in particular concrete construction, which he remembered being a good trade even during the Depression. From 1964 to 1994 my father and his brother Joe augmented the sale of eggs, cherries, and apricots with fireworks, pumpkins, and Christmas trees at the corner of California and Ortega, where the lot remains today. They donated Christmas trees to local parishes such as Saint Athanasius and Saint Joseph's, as well as El Camino Hospital on several occasions.

My father's ties to the family ranch remained throughout his life with the planting of an annual vegetable garden and his wish to see the remaining parcel on Ortega developed. As many of you know, he was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association, Napredak Club, Native Sons of the Golden West, and SIRS, from which he drew camaraderie and a connection to his heritage and agricultural and construction past. The Allis-Chalmers Model M Tractor and Meyers Sprayer on display at the Los Altos Heritage Museum are from the ranch and were donated by John in recognition of The Valley of Heart's Delight.



A rural Central Avenue c. 1964 with Moffett Blvd. on the left and Stevens Creek on the right.
Mountain View Public Library Photo Archives

Life on Central Avenue

By Gladys Robinson

Gladys Robinson is an MVHA member and retired painter of local landscapes. The following are selected excerpts from her written memories of life on Mountain View's Central Avenue. For the full version of her essay, e-mail mvha.newsletter@gmail.com.

After our MVHA meeting on November 8, 2011, I drove one block north and turned right. For memory's sake I wanted to see where I crossed the ford of Stevens Creek at the end of Central Avenue so many times. From the berm that has been set up at the end of the Avenue and the new Stevens Creek Trail bridge I could find no trace of the old road bed down and up the steep bank across the creek.

Grandpa and Grandma' place and walnut orchard was located nearby at 59 Central Avenue. When Moffett Field brought the sailors to Mountain View the family remodeled our tank house into a rental, my uncle Pete's bunk house became a rental, and a garage was moved and remodeled into a small apartment. The place became Anderson Court. I still remember our phone number, just 626.

Across the road lived our friends the Alfreds. They were old people who didn't farm their place so they had a glorious field of California poppies in the spring. I picked all the poppies my hands could hold to put in a jar on my bedroom dresser but they just wilted. Every day I carried a quart jar of our cow's milk across the road to their front porch. I never could stomach the warm milk right out of the cow. It didn't seem clean somehow, but through the cream separator and in the ice box it tasted good.

Down the street lived a Mexican man named Bailey, who lived with his family in a shack across the creek on the other bank. The Junior Chamber of Commerce hired him to make adobe bricks for the Adobe Building. I remember seeing dozens of bricks drying on the ground right out there in his yard. I used to think the Junior Chamber of Commerce was the most important organization in Mountain View because they were responsible for building the Adobe. They liked to party there - my mother told me one party got a little out of hand and a hunk of bread landed in the coffee cup of the Mayor's wife. The mayor disbanded the Junior Chamber of Commerce. I have never heard of any Junior Chamber of Commerce since.

The bank of Stevens Creek was a pleasant picnic spot in summer. My mother told me years ago she saw her mother spear a salmon in the creek. My Grandfather started a gravel business selling sand and gravel from the dry creek bed. After a storm, Stevens Creek was my rain gauge. I once saw the creek an angry torrent of muddy water that must have been five feet deep.

On Sunday morning once a year I woke up to the sound of parade drums coming from Stierlin Road. I would run down Central Avenue to see the beautiful dark haired Portuguese Queen and her princesses in their white satin gowns with sparkling silver crowns marching downtown to the Catholic church. How I longed to be a Portuguese princess; I was just a homely towhead.

These are some memories of my little world on Central Avenue, now "Gone with the Wind."

Membership

Membership Report

By June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of June 15, 2011

Honored Members	2
Life Members	116
Family Members	64
Single Members	107
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**289**

Welcome to our new members!

- Bob Armanansco, Ernest Baciocco, Robert Cox, Jon Garliepp, John Ross, and W. Shaughnessy

Join us today!

The Mountain View Historical Association welcomes new members. Any person who signifies interest in the aims of the Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member. The aims of the MVHA are:

- To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View.
- To collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area
- To preserve historic objects and places
- To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Membership Application & Renewal Form

- ☐ New membership
- ☐ Renewal
- ☐ REGULAR MEMBER: *$10/year*
- ☐ FAMILY MEMBER: *$15/year*
- ☐ LIFE TIME MEMBER: *$200*
- ☐ *Contact me for Volunteer opportunities*

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

CITY: _____

TELEPHONE _____

E-MAIL _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association

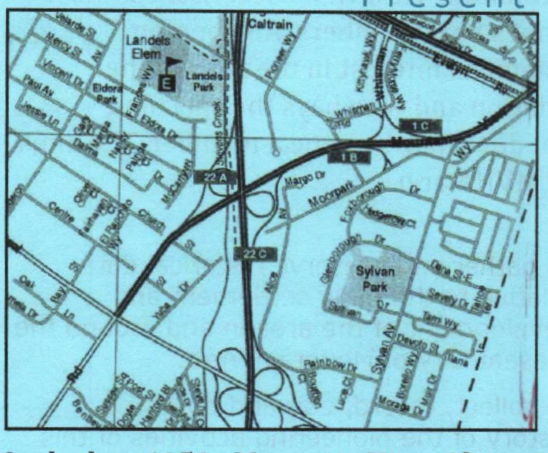
Mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
PO Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042

Street Talk

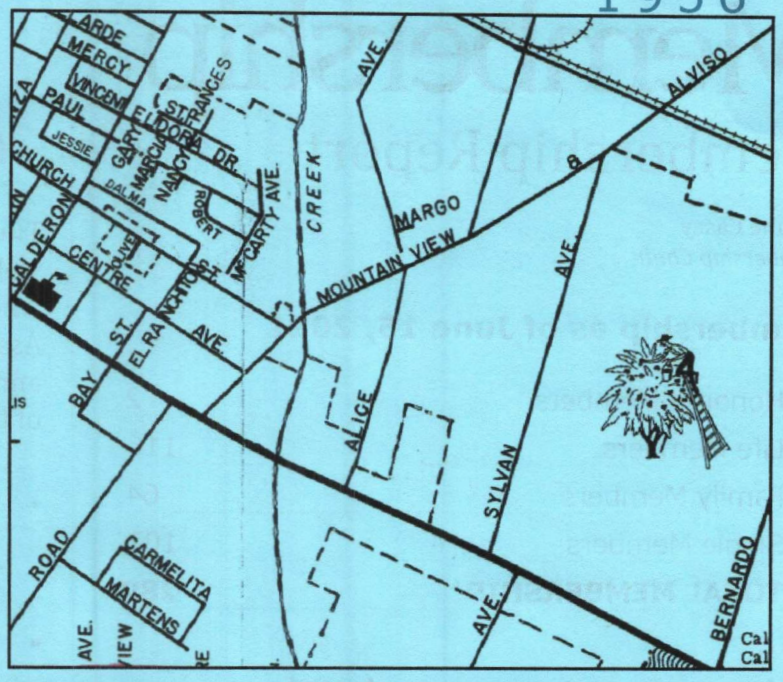
Mtn. View-Alviso → RD 100

By Barbara Kinchen
Historical Data Chair

Present



1956



In the late 1950s Mountain View-Alviso Road (now Highway 237) was realigned and the new Stevens Creek Freeway (Highway 85) was opened. These triggered several name changes for streets in the area between El Camino Real and the train tracks. Between El Camino and the bridge over Stevens Creek the old Alviso Road became Yuba Drive. North of the bridge it was renamed Moorpark Way. The northern portion of Alice Avenue became Pioneer Way.

Just in case you missed our BBQ order-form in the mail:

Order Form MVHA Barbeque

The MVHA's annual BBQ will be held on Sunday, August 7, 2011 at the Adobe Building at 157 Moffett Boulevard at Central Expressway. The menu will include: Zesty Hamubers (or Veggie Burgers), tossed green salad, potato salad, ice cream cups and cookies, and ice tea, lemonade, and water. Beer and wine will be also be available for $2 a glass (tickets available at the door). Doors open at 1pm for social hour with the BBQ beginning at 2pm, followed by a short business meeting, raffle, and silent auction. Need not be present to win the raffle. We hope you can join us!

BBQ Order Form – Please Send Form & Check by August 1st to:
MVHA BBQ, 3404 Ridgemont Drive, Mountain View, CA 94040

Name:_____
Name of Guests:_____
Street Address:_____
City:_____ **Zip:**_____
Phone Number:_____

Number of Adults: _____ **@ $10 each** = $_____
Number of Children: _____ **@ $5 each** = $_____
Number of Raffle Tickets** ____ **@ $5 for 6** = $_____

Total Amount Enclosed: $_____

**** If attending the BBQ your Raffle Tickets will be available when you check-in**